

Decide whether and how to invest in AI for a business opportunity; then examine the seven connected dimensions.

STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | Two-site manufacturer | Should AI support replacement-part purchasing? | Strategy workshop | No product or provider selected

Compare the potential upside (+), constraints (-) and unknowns (?) across dimensions before choosing a strategic direction.

GO

Opportunity

Problem / people / intended value
Alternatives / priority / scope

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Should the company invest in AI support for replacement-part purchasing? Delays can interrupt production, but buyers must also check price, availability and engineering suitability. Consider process improvement, better records, prediction, decision support and delegated action as different choices. Do not select a product yet.

1

Data

Sources & future value / Collect, acquire or label / Quality & coverage
Privacy & permitted use / Storage & access / Lifecycle & reuse

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Useful decisions require current specifications, supplier terms, stock positions and actual delivery outcomes. The company has some records but their quality, linkage and reuse rights are unknown. Start preserving corrections and outcomes; assess training, copyright, provider access and retention before choosing a route.

2

The AI team

Domain expertise / Technical skills / Communication & design
Obtain expertise / Retain & develop / Capacity & continuity

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Buyers and engineers hold essential domain knowledge; data engineering, evaluation and security capacity are not yet established. Internal capability may build long-term value but needs sustained staffing. Define which skills must remain inside the company even if software is bought.

3

Organising AI development

Position the team / Decision authority / Portfolio & timing
Existing service or product / Build, partner or acquire / Agility & operations

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Procurement should own the business goal with engineering, IT and data governance involved. Compare improving existing systems, buying a service, building internally and partnering. Funding and decision rights must be clear before procurement or development.

4

Technologies

Approach & simpler baseline / Model sourcing & adaptation / Performance & explainability
Human involvement / Hosting & infrastructure / Integration & lifecycle

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

The route is open: rules, prediction, a commercial service, a custom model or a hybrid workflow could help. In-house training needs usable data and specialists; SaaS trades speed for provider dependence and data exposure. Autonomous ordering is only a later option.

5

KPIs & value

Strategic outcome / Customer & user value / Process & people
Financial value / Model performance / Evidence & review

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Potential value includes fewer delays, better purchasing decisions and less manual comparison work. Current baselines, intervention costs and error rates are not established. Define how to measure business outcomes before claiming revenue, savings or avoided downtime.

6

Risk level & benefits

Performance uncertainty / Bias, ethics & safety / Security & resilience
Strategic dependence / Benefits & acceptable risk / SWOT & portfolio fit

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

A wrong part, price or commitment can harm operations. Confidential data may reach providers or connected systems, and authority can spread beyond intended tasks. Narrow permissions and human accountability are strategic requirements if any action capability is considered.

7

Culture & education

AI literacy / Roles & empowerment / Participation & ideas
Shared expertise / Continuous education / Adoption in practice

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Buyers and engineers must help define the problem, usable evidence and acceptable authority. Skills in data quality and AI judgement need development whether the company builds or buys. Adoption should be judged by better decisions and manageable work, not usage alone.

STRATEGIC DIRECTION: invest / prepare / defer / reject | conditions / owner / review date

STRATEGIC DIRECTION: prepare a conditional investment in AI-supported purchasing decisions. First strengthen purchasing records, map the decision process, assign owners and establish business baselines. Then compare no-AI improvement, SaaS, internal development and partnership against agreed criteria. Select no vendor, model or live trial in this strategy stage. Procurement sponsor reviews the evidence and decides whether a feasibility stage is justified.

Sources, rights and useful information
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For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

1.1 Sources & future value

READINESS

+ Supported

What exists internally or externally? What outcomes and corrections should we capture now for later uses?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.1

Purchasing AI would need current specifications, supplier terms, stock positions and delivery outcomes linked by part and order.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Specifications and supplier records already exist.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Outcomes and buyer corrections are not linked for learning.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Data lead: inventory sources and missing links.

1.2 Collect, acquire or label

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare collection time, purchased data and expert annotation. What permissions, copyright terms and costs apply?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.1

Custom training may need labelled examples of acceptable substitutions and decisions. Estimate whether existing histories can be used or expert labels must be created.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Buyers and engineers can define useful labels.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Label volume, effort and document rights are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Data lead: estimate labels, rights and collection effort.

1.3 Quality & coverage

READINESS

? Unknown

Do volume, variety and freshness fit the task? Which populations, periods, labels or edge cases are missing?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.1

Any approach needs reliable units, revisions, prices and delivery dates. Assess coverage before assuming model training or automated comparison is feasible.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Core fields are known to purchasing staff.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Formats vary and older records may omit revisions.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Buyer: sample records for completeness and drift.

1.4 Privacy & permitted use

READINESS

? Unknown

Can providers train on proprietary inputs or outputs? Check permitted recipients, training use, retention, access and exceptions.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

2021 + extension

Commercial services may receive prompts, files and outputs; internal models still need access controls. Decide what data can leave the company and under which terms.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Sensitive sources can be identified by owners.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Training use, retention and onward access need review.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Data owner: set permitted data-use boundaries.

1.5 Storage & access

READINESS

? Unknown

Where should data live? Consider structure, proximity, transfer speed, security, capacity and administration.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.3

A purchasing capability would need governed storage and controlled access to specifications, quotes and outcomes. Hosting follows the data classification and chosen route.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

IT already administers business data stores.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Cross-system access and model logs are unmapped.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

IT: map data flows and access requirements.

1.6 Lifecycle & reuse

READINESS

- Gap

How will sources, versions, corrections and outcomes stay linked? Set retention, deletion and recovery arrangements.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

Keep corrected quotes, decisions and actual delivery outcomes when permitted. Their future value extends to forecasting and supplier analysis even if AI is deferred.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Historical purchasing records provide a start.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Retention and provenance rules are incomplete.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Data owner: propose record linkage and retention.

For LLMs: trace prompts, retrieval and provider retention/training. For trained models: separate training, validation and test data.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency
The data foundation is promising but incomplete. Training a custom system would require linked decisions, outcomes and expert labels. A service would still require data-use terms and governed access.

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER
Data lead: inventory source quality, rights and missing outcomes before choosing a build or service route.

Dorien Herremans | aiSTROM (2021) | Basis: III-B | Card labels are practical groupings; additions marked.

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Capabilities, sourcing and continuity
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For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

2.1 Domain expertise

READINESS

+ Supported

Who understands the task and recognises a plausible but wrong result? Include people affected by the workflow.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

Buyers judge commercial terms; engineers judge technical suitability. Any AI route depends on these experts defining valid decisions and unacceptable errors.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Both groups understand failure consequences.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Their time for data and governance work is limited.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: estimate domain-expert capacity.

2.2 Technical skills

READINESS

- Gap

Which statistics, data engineering, modelling and software skills does this project actually need?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

A custom route needs data engineering, modelling, evaluation and integration skills. SaaS reduces model development but still needs technical assessment and oversight.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

IT knows the purchasing environment.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

AI evaluation and data skills are not mapped.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

IT lead: map skills against each route.

2.3 Communication & design

READINESS

? Unknown

Who translates between specialists and decision makers? Who designs understandable outputs and interfaces?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

Users need sources, constraints and uncertainty presented clearly. Design capability is needed whether the interface is bought or built.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Buyers can state what evidence they need.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No shared standard for understandable advice exists.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Buyer lead: define evidence and explanation needs.

2.4 Obtain expertise

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare upskilling, hiring, partnerships and acquiring a team. Which capabilities must remain internally?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

Compare training staff, hiring, partnering and buying. Keep the ability to define the task, evaluate quality and govern data internally under every route.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Internal domain expertise can anchor the work.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Specialist capacity and recruitment cost are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: cost capability options and retention.

2.5 Retain & develop

READINESS

? Unknown

How will people learn, share knowledge and stay? Is time for education and technical investigation funded?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

A purchase can accelerate delivery but may leave the company unable to adapt or challenge it. Budget learning and knowledge transfer as part of any route.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Teams already share operational know-how.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No plan protects AI knowledge from turnover.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

HR and IT: outline a learning and handover plan.

2.6 Capacity & continuity

READINESS

? Unknown

Who has time to review, maintain and support the system? Name backups and unresolved skill bottlenecks.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

A live capability requires ongoing review, incident handling and maintenance. Compare that commitment with expected value before approving development or procurement.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Existing IT support roles provide a base.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No owner or budget for AI operations exists.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: estimate long-term support capacity.

For fine-tuning: name data-curation and model-evaluation skills. For agents: include integration and permission-testing expertise.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

The company has buyer and engineering expertise. Internal development needs additional AI and data capacity; a purchased service still needs internal task, evaluation and governance owners.

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Sponsor: map existing capacity and the long-term skills required under each route.

Structure, delivery and portfolio
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3.1 Position the team

READINESS

? Unknown

Centralised, distributed or hub-and-spoke? Which arrangement enables shared expertise and access across departments?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

Use procurement as business owner, with engineering, IT and data governance as shared partners. Decide whether a central AI group is needed for reuse across functions.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Decision expertise spans known departments.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Cross-team capacity and authority are unclear.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Executive sponsor: propose ownership structure.

3.2 Decision authority

READINESS

- Gap

Who owns budget, outcomes and access? Which people must be involved to avoid delays and unclear responsibility?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

Separate authority to set the strategy, approve data access, spend funds and permit automated actions. These decisions should not default to the software team.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Procurement can name an accountable sponsor.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Data and action approval rights are unstated.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: document decision rights and gates.

3.3 Portfolio & timing

READINESS

+ Supported

Balance near-term improvements and longer-term exploration. Which projects share capabilities or compete for resources?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

Purchasing AI competes with stock alerts, supplier-data cleanup and other AI opportunities. Compare value and shared data foundations before prioritising it.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Several paths may reduce disruption.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Relative costs and benefits are not ranked.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Strategy group: compare portfolio alternatives.

3.4 Existing service or product

READINESS

? Unknown

Could software or AI as a service meet the need? Consider configuration, provider dependence and price changes.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

Assess whether existing purchasing software or a service could meet the need. Include configuration limits, exportability, pricing and dependence, without selecting a provider yet.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

A current platform offers a starting point.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Feature gaps and commercial terms are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

IT: list requirements for later market review.

3.5 Build, partner or acquire

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare internal development, outsourcing and acquiring technology. Consider retained knowledge and maintenance.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

Compare internal build, SaaS and partnership against data control, adaptability, speed, cost and retained capability. Acquisition is one route, not the strategic conclusion.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

The organisation can compare several routes.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No whole-life cost or exit criteria exist.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: prepare a build-buy-partner scorecard.

3.6 Agility & operations

READINESS

? Unknown

What evidence should be gathered before committing to a delivery route? Separate strategic direction from later prototypes, procurement and operation.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

The strategy should identify evidence needed for a later feasibility stage. A prototype, vendor review or procurement belongs after the direction and decision criteria are agreed.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

A staged decision process is possible.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No investment gates have been defined.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: define the next-stage evidence gate.

Keep application delivery separate from model sourcing and hosting. A system built internally can still depend on an external model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency
Procurement should own the business decision, with engineering, IT and governance involved. Compare purchasing-system improvement, SaaS, internal build and partnership at a later gate.

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER
Sponsor: assign authority and agree criteria for the next investment decision.

Dorien Herremans | aiSTROM (2021) | Basis: III-D | Card labels are practical groupings; additions marked.

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Models, people and deployment
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

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For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

4.1 Approach & simpler baseline

READINESS

+ Supported

Could rules, optimisation or ordinary software solve the task? Compare predictive, generative and hybrid approaches.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

First ask whether better rules, records or alerts could solve the problem. Prediction and generative support may help different decisions; use AI only where it adds value.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

The current process can be mapped.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

The relative value of simpler options is unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Operations lead: map tasks and alternatives.

4.2 Model sourcing & adaptation

READINESS

? Unknown

Use an existing model, adapter, fine-tuning or custom training? What task evidence, data, licences and skills justify it?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

Custom training needs usable histories, labels and specialist skills. SaaS or an existing model may be faster, but creates provider dependence and data questions.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Several technical routes remain open.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No evidence yet justifies training a model.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

AI lead: state prerequisites for each route.

4.3 Performance & explainability

READINESS

? Unknown

What performance and explanations must any approach provide? Which errors or uncertainties would make AI unsuitable?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

Any route must reveal source evidence and uncertainty for consequential decisions. Define acceptable errors before comparing models or services.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Engineers can define critical constraints.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Explanation and error tolerance are unset.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Engineering: define unacceptable decision errors.

4.4 Human involvement

READINESS

? Unknown

Who labels or corrects examples? Which tasks are augmented or automated, and which judgements remain with people?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

Decide which judgements stay with buyers and engineers. Assistance, recommendation and delegated ordering have different data, control and liability demands.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Human expertise is available to retain.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No agreed boundary for delegated action exists.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Procurement: map decisions and authority levels.

4.5 Hosting & infrastructure

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare cloud, managed service, on-premises and edge. Include training/inference needs, capital and operating costs.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

Internal hosting can increase control but requires infrastructure and staff. Managed services reduce setup work but may constrain data handling and portability.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

IT can describe current infrastructure.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Capacity, cost and data-location needs are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

IT: estimate hosting needs by route.

4.6 Integration & lifecycle

READINESS

? Unknown

How do inputs and outputs connect to work? Define versioning, updates, monitoring, fallback and action boundaries.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

Useful advice must connect to purchasing records and current workflows. Any later integration needs monitoring, versioning, fallback and restricted permissions.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Current systems provide integration points.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Interfaces, ownership and recovery needs vary.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

IT: map dependencies and action boundaries.

For LLMs: compare retrieval and adaptation. For agents: list permitted tools/actions and approvals enforced outside the model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

No technology route is selected. The strategy compares process fixes, rules, prediction, generative support and later autonomous action by what each would require and enable.

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

AI lead: describe data, skills, infrastructure and authority required for each plausible route.

Outcomes, measurement and continuation
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

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For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

5.1 Strategic outcome

READINESS

+ Supported

What business outcome would make AI worth considering? Identify the current baseline and a meaningful future measure.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

The strategic goal is fewer avoidable production delays and better purchasing decisions. Establish a baseline before attributing any improvement to AI.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Business disruption is a recognised concern.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Current delay causes and costs are unmeasured.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Finance and procurement: define baseline measures.

5.2 Customer & user value

READINESS

? Unknown

Could value mean better service, easier decisions or a new offering? Who benefits and how will you observe it?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

Buyers may gain clearer evidence and faster choices; production may gain reliability. Ask users which benefit matters and what trade-offs they would accept.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Users can describe difficult decisions.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

User value has not been systematically gathered.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Buyer lead: interview affected teams.

5.3 Process & people

READINESS

? Unknown

Measure time, quality, rework and workload across the whole workflow. Where will released capacity be used?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

Include total review work, rework and exception handling, not just automated steps. AI can shift effort rather than remove it.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Workflow steps can be mapped.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Current time and correction burden are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Operations: document end-to-end work.

5.4 Financial value

READINESS

? Unknown

Consider revenue, margin, investment and ongoing costs. Separate staff capacity from realised cash savings.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

Compare likely investment and ongoing costs with realistic financial benefit. Released staff capacity differs from cash savings; avoided downtime needs evidence.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Finance can assess competing investments.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No cost range or benefits baseline exists.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Finance: create scenario ranges by route.

5.5 Model performance

READINESS

- Gap

Which task measures and consequential errors would later determine whether an approach is adequate?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

Define future standards for field accuracy, missed constraints, unstable outputs and harmful recommendations. Measures should reflect the purchasing task, not generic model scores.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Critical errors can be named by experts.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No task-specific evaluation standard exists.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Evaluation lead: draft quality criteria.

5.6 Evidence & review

READINESS

? Unknown

What evidence would justify investing, changing direction or stopping? Who owns the later measurement?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

Agree what later evidence would support investing, changing route or stopping. The strategic sheet records the decision criteria; testing occurs in a later stage.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

A review gate can be set now.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No owner or evidence timetable exists.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: assign measures and review gate.

For generators: use task rubrics and review effort. For agents: measure completed work and action errors, not just answer quality.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency
Value is plausible but unquantified. The company needs business baselines, end-to-end workload measures and task-specific quality standards before any offer or trial is judged.

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER
Finance and procurement: agree baseline measures and investment criteria.

Uncertainty, trade-offs and SWOT
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For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

6.1 Performance uncertainty

READINESS

? Unknown

What if useful accuracy cannot be reached or conditions change? Which uncertainty is decisive before investment?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.1

Assess how wrong prices, compatibility advice or demand forecasts could affect production. Different AI roles have different failure costs.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Consequences can be described by operations.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Error likelihood and reversibility are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Risk lead: rank consequential failure modes.

6.2 Bias, ethics & safety

READINESS

? Unknown

Who could be disadvantaged or harmed? Consider historical bias, missed errors and responsibility for consequences.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

2021 + extension

Historical purchasing data may reflect supplier bias. Technical mistakes can create safety and quality problems; accountability must remain clear.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Engineering can identify critical parts.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Fairness and safety impacts are unmapped.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Engineering: define exclusions and oversight.

6.3 Security & resilience

READINESS

- Gap

What deceptive inputs, data access or compromised components could cause harm? How will you detect and contain it?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

2021 + extension

A service may expose confidential terms; integrated systems may be reached through compromised access. Agentic action would add prompt-injection and permission risks.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Existing security governance can be used.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Data flows and future tool reach are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Security: set required controls by autonomy level.

6.4 Strategic dependence

READINESS

? Unknown

How exposed are we to unfamiliar technology, skill gaps, vendors, price changes or organisational dependencies?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.1

An internal build depends on scarce skills; SaaS depends on provider prices, terms and continuity. Compare both forms of dependence in the strategy.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Multiple routes avoid one fixed dependency.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Switching and maintenance costs are unknown.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

IT: map dependency and exit criteria.

6.5 Benefits & acceptable risk

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare expected value with the size and reversibility of possible losses. Who can accept the remaining exposure?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.2-3

Faster decisions may justify some investment, but not an undefined authority to spend or substitute parts. The sponsor must state acceptable exposure for each AI role.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Benefits can be tied to purchasing goals.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Risk appetite for automated actions is unset.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: define acceptable decision authority.

6.6 SWOT & portfolio fit

READINESS

? Unknown

Bring the findings together: internal strengths and weaknesses; external opportunities and threats. What changes the choice?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.3

Strengths include domain expertise; weaknesses include fragmented outcomes. Opportunities span better records and advice; threats include disruption and provider dependence.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

The SWOT exposes connected choices.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Portfolio priority still needs evidence.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Strategy group: connect SWOT to investment choice.

For agents: test prompt injection, tool misuse and reach into other systems. For predictive models: test drift and adversarial inputs.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency
Wrong component advice, data exposure and provider dependence are strategic concerns. Delegated ordering would increase reach and requires a separate decision on authority and acceptable exposure.

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER
Risk lead: rank harms and set minimum controls for each autonomy level.

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Participation, literacy and lasting use
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For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

7.1 AI literacy

READINESS

? Unknown

What should leaders, users and wider staff understand about AI capabilities, limitations and appropriate uses?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

Leaders need to understand what AI can and cannot justify; buyers and engineers need to know how to question output. Literacy needs differ by role.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

People know the current purchasing task.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

AI knowledge and confidence vary.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Learning lead: map role-specific literacy needs.

7.2 Roles & empowerment

READINESS

? Unknown

How will work and authority change? Discuss concerns, preserve useful expertise and identify where AI supports people.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H; III-E

AI could shift buyers toward judgement and exception handling. Include staff in deciding which tasks are supported and which authority must remain human.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Experienced staff can shape the design.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Workload and trust effects are uncertain.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Procurement: discuss future roles with staff.

7.3 Participation & ideas

READINESS

+ Supported

How can staff help identify opportunities, shape the workflow and challenge unhelpful designs?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

Invite buyers, engineers and production staff to identify worthwhile opportunities and hidden constraints before choosing technology.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Affected teams know practical pain points.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Their ideas have not been collected together.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: hold a cross-functional workshop.

7.4 Shared expertise

READINESS

? Unknown

Would a centre of excellence or lighter community help? Decide how knowledge, examples and specialists are shared.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

A small shared expert group may help purchasing and other functions reuse data standards, methods and lessons. Scale the structure only if demand warrants it.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

IT and domain networks already exist.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No owner curates reusable AI knowledge.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Leadership: decide how expertise is shared.

7.5 Continuous education

READINESS

? Unknown

Plan ongoing learning for developers, managers and users. Who updates guidance as systems and tasks change?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

Any adopted capability will change with data, models, suppliers and rules. Plan continuing education as an operating cost under build and buy routes.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

Change triggers can be identified early.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

Time and funding for refreshers are unset.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Sponsor: include learning in cost estimates.

7.6 Adoption in practice

READINESS

? Unknown

What would appropriate use look like if adopted? How would the organisation notice burden, errors or avoidance?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

Successful adoption means better decisions with manageable review effort, appropriate rejection and retained expertise. Usage alone would be a weak measure.

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

The desired behaviour can be described.

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

No adoption baseline or feedback route exists.

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Procurement: define adoption signals and feedback.

Tailor practice to the system: interpreting forecasts, checking generated content, or supervising and stopping delegated actions.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

Buyers and engineers should shape the opportunity and retain meaningful authority. Learning and organisational change cost time under both internal and SaaS routes.

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Learning lead: define skills, participation and adoption measures for the next strategy review.